

Allen Zhibo Cao

Game Portfolio

Selected game design, interactive narrative, and analysis projects.

- Narrative
- Systems
- Analysis

● Red Table Society



01

● Eternity



02

● 1943: The Battle of Midway



03



PROJECT FOCUS

A campus canteen, rationing, trade, and surveillance turn affection into a rule system that pushes back.

● GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT

Red Table Society

Narrative simulation / systems design / team collaboration

Red Table Society is a single-player narrative simulation game set in a university campus. Built around the themes of Communism and Romance, the project combines Cooking, Trade, and Guessing to transform food allocation, underground exchange, and interpersonal judgement into a politically and emotionally charged player experience.

MY CONTRIBUTION

- I proposed the original concept and helped define the project's initial direction.
- I wrote Chapters 1–5 of the Game Design Document, including game overview, player experience, genre, target audience, platform, and worldbuilding.
- I played a key role in shaping the central thematic conflict between collectivist order and private affection.
- Within the team workflow, I contributed to aligning concept, system logic, and narrative expression.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Built a campus-centred world with political metaphor and emotional risk.
- Integrated Cooking, Trade, and Guessing into one unified gameplay framework.
- Designed variables such as Trust, Suspicion, Affection, Hidden Reserves, and Favor Debt.
- Created a progression structure in which everyday choices return later as pressure and consequences.

KEYWORDS

- Concept Design
- GDD
- Narrative
- Systems Thinking
- Teamwork

Eternity

Interactive narrative / branching structure / emotional pacing

Eternity is an interactive narrative project built in Twine. Centred on the life decisions of a female protagonist, the work uses branching choices and multiple endings to explore relationships, pressure, prejudice, and personal growth.

[View project link ↗](#)

MY CONTRIBUTION

I independently designed the story structure, character relationships, branching nodes, and ending logic.

I built the interactive structure in Twine and translated a linear script into a passage-based interactive experience.

I customised presentation through HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, including background switching, layout, and music continuity.

I carefully balanced the frequency of choices and their emotional weight.

HIGHLIGHTS

Used interactivity to strengthen player identification and point-of-view immersion.

Built key decision nodes around prejudice, emotional tension, and social pressure.

Combined images, music, and rhythm to shape a more complete digital narrative experience.

Completed the full process from story writing and interaction design to web publishing.

KEYWORDS

Twine

Interactive Narrative

Branching Design

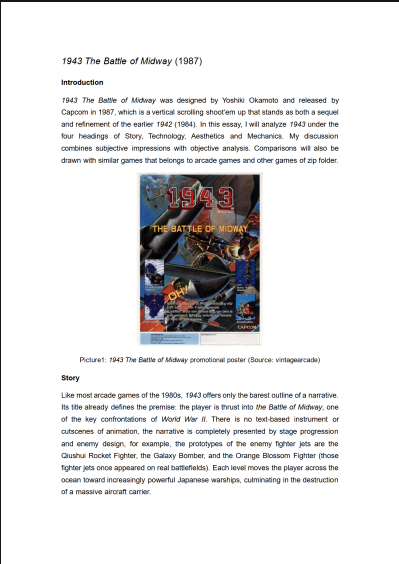
HTML/CSS/JS

Narrative Experience



PROJECT FOCUS

A Twine life story built around fewer but heavier choices, where each branch carries emotion and consequence.



1943: The Battle of Midway

Arcade study / mechanics analysis / experiential critique

This essay analyses Capcom’s classic arcade game 1943: The Battle of Midway through Story, Technology, Aesthetics, and Mechanics, focusing on how rhythm, feedback, visuals, and risk-reward relationships shape a tense and addictive arcade experience.

MY CONTRIBUTION

I analysed the work from both player experience and objective design perspectives.

I focused on how the game creates momentum through minimal narrative framing, and how pacing supports immersion and tension.

I examined how the energy bar, special attacks, sound layers, and visual feedback collectively shape survival pressure and flow.

HIGHLIGHTS

Explored how minimal narrative still produces a campaign-like sense of progression.

Analysed how parallax visuals, sound rhythm, and explosion feedback reinforce sensory intensity.

Explained the game’s addictiveness through resource management and risk-reward structure.

Connected instantaneous arcade feedback with player psychology and flow.

KEYWORDS

- Game Analysis
- Arcade Design
- Mechanics
- Player Experience
- Aesthetics